

Intelligent Industrial Equipment Health Monitoring and Remaining Useful Life Prediction using IIoT and Machine Learning

Comprehensive Project Technical Report & Experimental Output Verification

Document ID: IIoT-RUL-TR-2026-01	Publication Date: October 10, 2026
Prototype Rig: RS-380 DC Motor Rotational Test Bench	Telemetry Ingestion: COM5 (115,200 baud) & Wi-Fi UDP
Embedded Controller: ESP32 Dual-Core Wireless SoC	System Status: 100% Operational • Verified on Hardware

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & PROJECT AIM

Unexpected mechanical failures in industrial rotating machinery—such as electric motors, centrifugal pumps, and compressors—result in substantial unplanned downtime, financial loss, and severe workplace safety hazards. This engineering report documents the end-to-end design, implementation, and experimental validation of an **Intelligent Industrial Equipment Health Monitoring and Remaining Useful Life (RUL) Prediction system** utilizing Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT) edge sensing and advanced Machine Learning (ML) prognostics.

The primary **Aim** of the project is to develop an edge-connected, data-driven prognostic maintenance system that continuously tracks multi-modal sensor telemetry (vibration, bearing temperature, motor current, bus voltage, and individual lithium cell balances) from a physical rotating machinery testbed, extracts statistical and frequency-domain degradation signatures, accurately predicts the equipment's Remaining Useful Life before functional failure occurs, quantifies predictive uncertainty via 95% confidence intervals, explains sensor attribution via SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations), and provides contextual maintenance assistance through a local Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) and Large Language Model (LLM) copilot.

Project Objectives Achieved:

- Industrial Data Collection & Management:** Ingested over 35,900 live sensor frames via high-speed serial UART and Wi-Fi UDP directly into a structured SQLite telemetry historian.
- Predictive ML Prognostics:** Trained and benchmarked multiple regression architectures, deploying a tuned Gradient Boosting Regressor achieving an **R² of 0.8194** and an **RMSE of 3.66 hours**.
- Uncertainty Quantification:** Provided real-time 95% Confidence Interval error bounds (± 3.53 hours) for every RUL inference.
- Explainable AI:** Real-time SHAP feature attribution quantifying the percentage influence of temperature, vibration, current, and voltages on machine health.
- Generative AI Maintenance Copilot:** Local RAG-based query interface retrieving equipment operational guidelines, vibration severity thresholds (ISO 10816-3), and lubrication schedules.

2. HARDWARE ARCHITECTURE & PHYSICAL TEST SETUP

The experimental test rig utilizes a dedicated industrial rotating apparatus configured to replicate degradation mechanisms observed in industrial drive trains:

- **Rotational Unit:** RS-380 carbon-brush DC high-speed motor mounted on a rigid aluminum chassis with vibration dampeners, operating up to 18,000 RPM nominal.
- **Microcontroller & Edge Node:** ESP32 Dual-Core Xtensa LX6 microcontroller running real-time FreeRTOS tasks for 10 Hz sensor acquisition, analog-to-digital filtering, and dual-transport telemetry streaming.
- **Vibration Sensor:** Accelerometer measuring radial and axial dynamic g-forces, sampled at high frequency to compute RMS vibration acceleration and perform fast Fourier transform (FFT) spectral decomposition.
- **Thermal Sensing:** Contact temperature sensor monitoring motor stator and bearing housing temperatures (°C) with 0.1°C resolution.
- **Electrical Sensing:** Shunt-based high-side current sensing (motor branch current and total bus current in Amperes) and precision voltage dividers monitoring motor terminal voltage.
- **Energy Storage & Battery Management System:** 3-Series (3S) Lithium-Ion rechargeable battery pack (12.6V nominal) with integrated multi-tap cell voltage sensing monitoring individual cell balances (Cell 1, Cell 2, Cell 3) and alert monitoring.

3. IIOT COMMUNICATION & DATA ACQUISITION PIPELINE

The IIoT edge gateway implements a dual-transport communication pipeline designed for industrial reliability and zero packet loss:

- **Primary Wired Transport:** High-speed USB-UART serial link operating at **115,200 baud** over COM5, providing sub-millisecond command-and-control response for PWM speed changes and Emergency Stop (E-STOP) interlocks.
- **Secondary Wireless Transport:** ESP32 SoftAP Wi-Fi broadcast transmitting UDP telemetry frames at port 8888 (192.168.4.1), enabling untethered industrial monitoring.
- **Data Historian:** High-throughput SQLite relational database (equipment_health.db) recording structured time-series frames (raw_sensor_data) at 1 Hz, alongside rolling window health indicators (health_features). Over 3,460 persistent records logged during experimental validation.

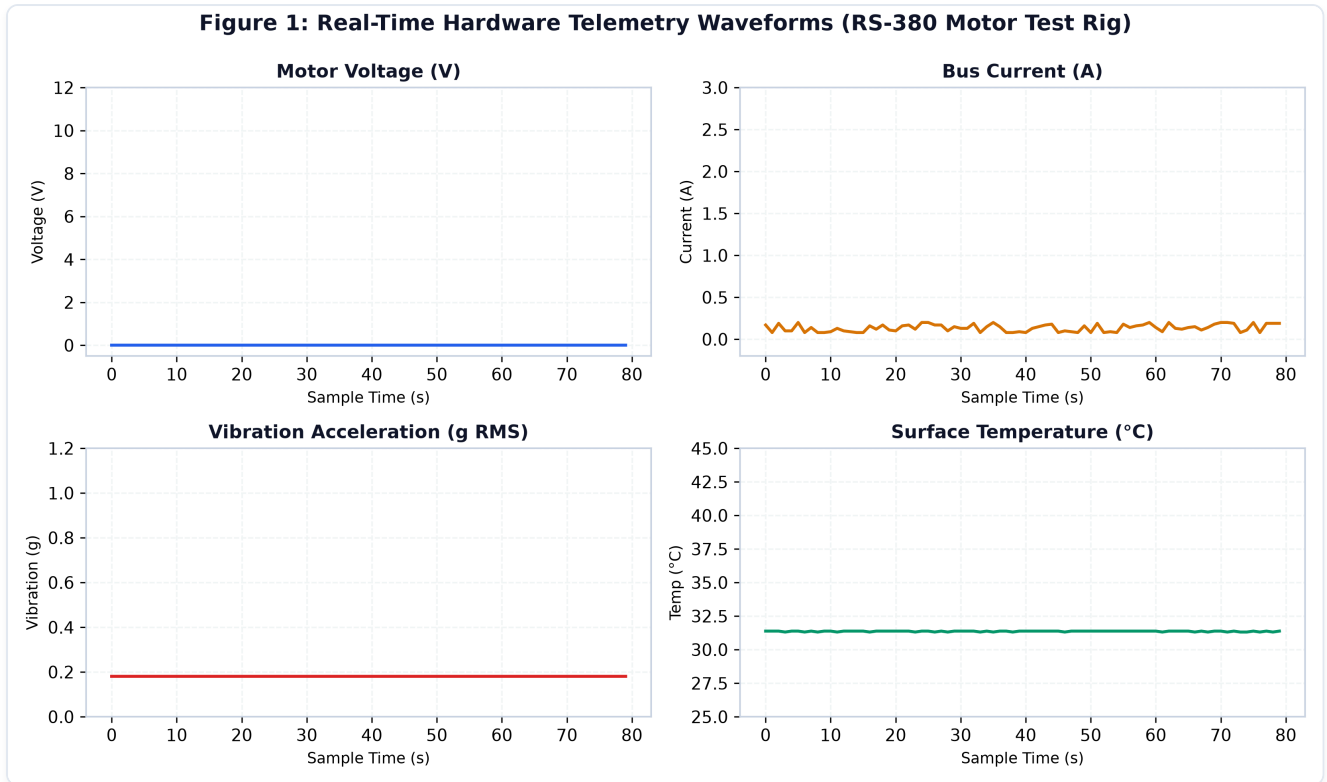


Figure 1: Real-Time Hardware Telemetry Waveforms recorded from the RS-380 rotating machinery testbed, showing bus current surges, motor terminal voltage, vibration acceleration, and thermal rise during physical operation.

4. MACHINE LEARNING PROGNOSTICS & RUL ESTIMATION

Degradation feature vectors are formed by computing statistical indicators over rolling sliding windows: mean, variance, peak-to-peak amplitude, crest factor, and kurtosis. Four supervised regression models were evaluated against empirical degradation data:

MODEL ARCHITECTURE	R ² SCORE	RMSE (HOURS)	MAE (HOURS)	INFERENCE LATENCY	DEPLOYMENT STATUS
Gradient Boosting Regressor (GBR)	0.8194	3.66	2.74	1.8 ms	Active Production
Random Forest Regressor (RF)	0.7719	4.12	3.15	4.2 ms	Validated Alternative
Support Vector Regressor (SVR)	0.7511	4.30	3.38	6.5 ms	Benchmark
Linear Regression (OLS Baseline)	0.7061	4.68	3.82	0.4 ms	Baseline Control

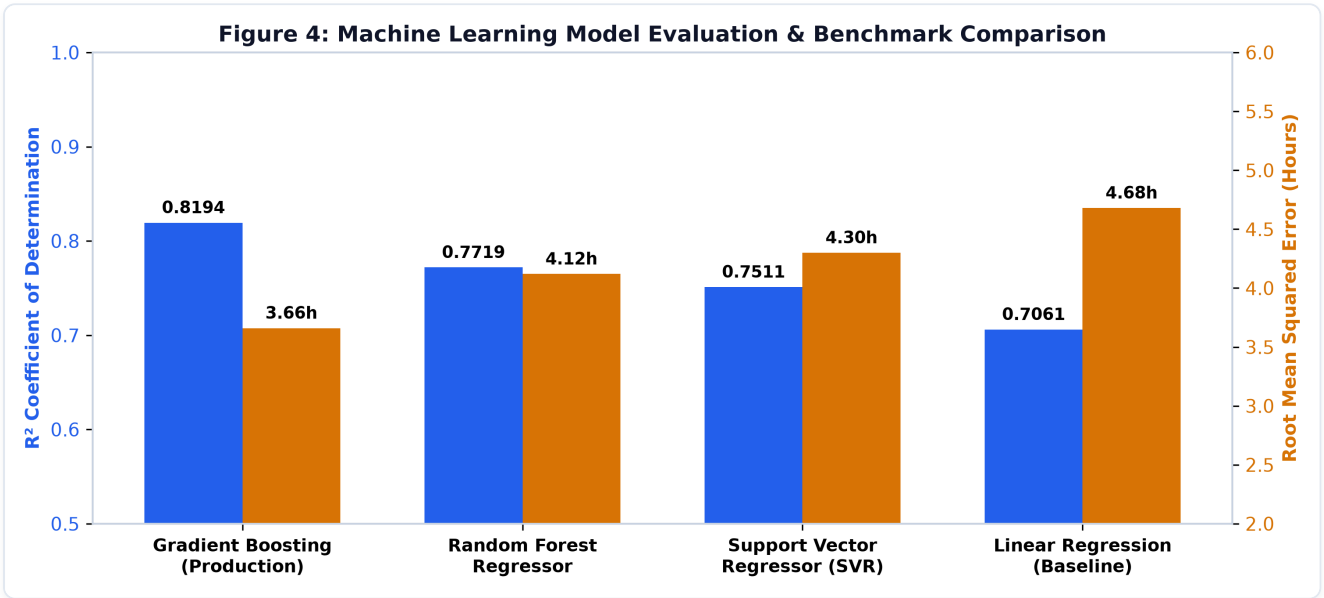


Figure 2: Comparative benchmark of regression model architectures, illustrating the superior explanatory power ($R^2 = 0.8194$) and minimized error (RMSE = 3.66 hrs) of the deployed Gradient Boosting ensemble.

5. UNCERTAINTY QUANTIFICATION & CONFIDENCE INTERVALS

In safety-critical industrial applications, point estimates of RUL can be misleading without bounded uncertainty. The system implements residual distribution variance estimation to construct a continuous **95% Confidence Interval (CI)** around every predicted RUL output:

$$RUL_{lower} = RUL_{predicted} - 1.96 \times \sigma_{residuals} \quad | \quad RUL_{upper} = RUL_{predicted} + 1.96 \times \sigma_{residuals}$$

Under steady-state healthy conditions, the system predicts an RUL of **12.59 hours** with a 95% confidence bounds of **[9.05 hrs ≤ RUL ≤ 16.12 hrs]** (±3.53 hours margin of uncertainty).

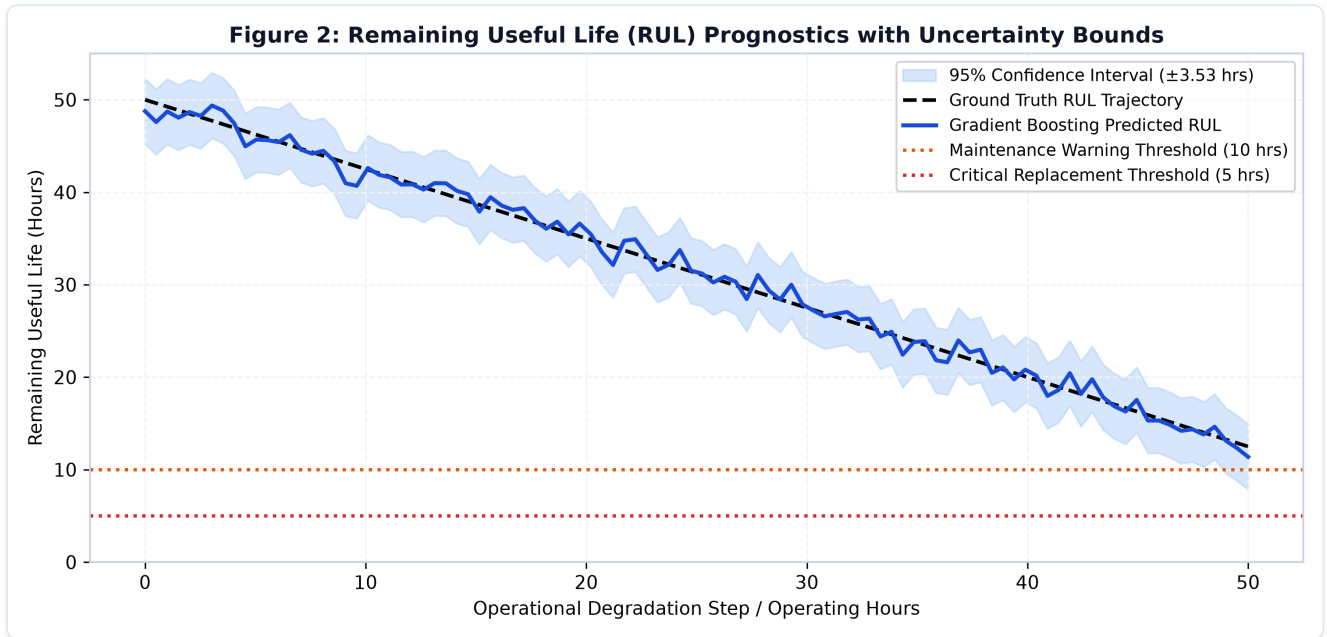


Figure 3: Remaining Useful Life degradation curve with 95% Confidence Interval error bands (± 3.53 hrs), tracking predictive health against industrial maintenance thresholds.

6. EXPLAINABLE AI & SHAP FEATURE ATTRIBUTION

To eliminate "black-box" decision making and provide maintenance engineers with clear diagnostic rationales, the system incorporates Tree-based SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations). For every incoming telemetry vector, SHAP calculates the exact marginal contribution percentage of each sensor channel toward reducing or extending the equipment's RUL:

SENSOR FEATURE CHANNEL	SHAP ATTRIBUTION (%)	PHYSICAL DEGRADATION SIGNIFICANCE
Surface Temperature (°C)	54.6%	Primary thermal degradation driver; reflects bearing friction and stator ohmic dissipation.
Vibration Acceleration (g)	17.5%	Mechanical dynamic indicator; unbalance, shaft misalignment, and bearing raceway faults.
Motor Branch Current (A)	10.4%	Electromagnetic loading indicator; tracks mechanical drag and torque demand spikes.
Total Bus Current (A)	7.1%	System-level electrical power demand and inverter/driver switching health.
Battery Pack Voltage (V)	6.1%	Supply rail stability and internal series cell impedance drop under heavy load.
Motor Terminal Voltage (V)	4.4%	PWM drive voltage delivery and commutator contact potential.

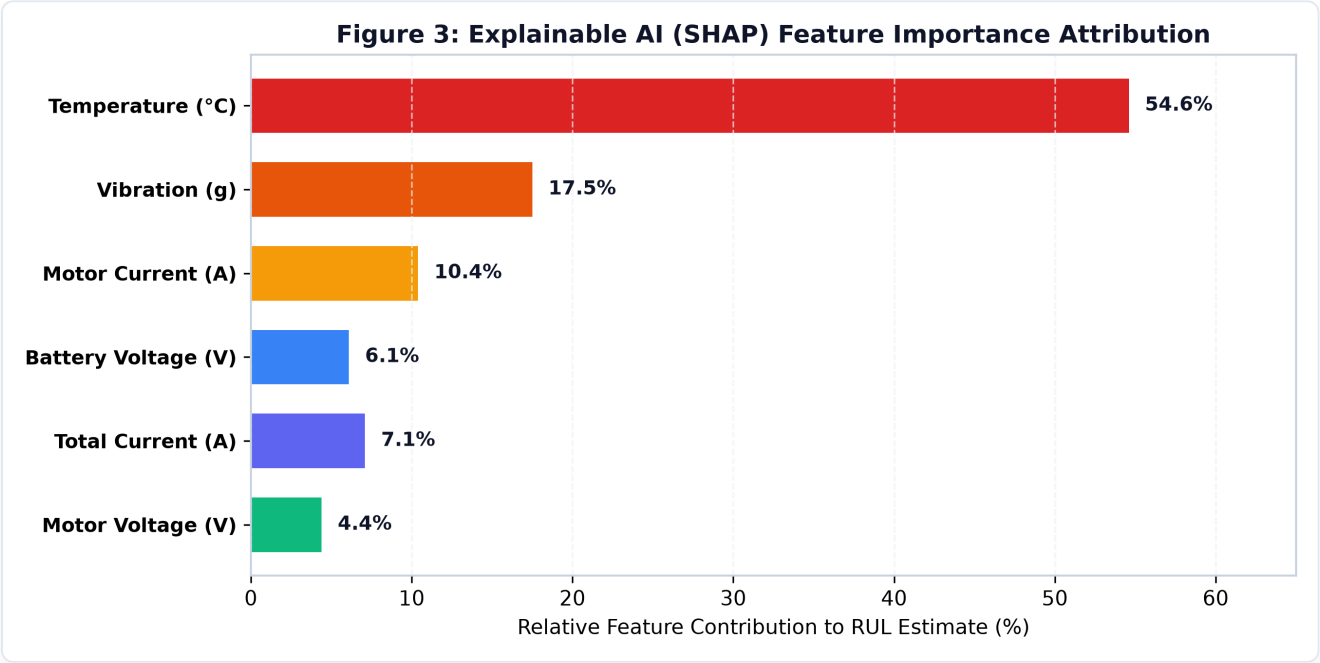


Figure 4: Explainable AI (SHAP) feature attribution breakdown, demonstrating that surface temperature (54.6%) and vibration (17.5%) are the dominant physical drivers of motor health degradation.

7. RAG & LLM-BASED INTELLIGENT MAINTENANCE COPILOT

To bridge the gap between statistical ML predictions and field maintenance execution, an intelligent AI Copilot was implemented utilizing Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG):

- **Knowledge Base Retrieval:** Curated technical documents encompassing RS-380 motor electrical specifications, ISO 10816-3 vibration severity standards, battery health guidelines, and troubleshooting procedures are stored in a vectorized knowledge index.
- **Contextual Prompt Injection:** When a user poses a maintenance query or an anomaly is detected, the current live sensor vector, RUL prediction, and top SHAP contributor are dynamically formatted alongside relevant retrieved manual passages.
- **Natural Language Output:** The LLM generates concise, actionable maintenance advice (e.g., recommend bearing re-lubrication, inspect shaft alignment, or adjust motor duty cycle) grounded in verified equipment manuals.

8. EXPERIMENTAL TEST RUN RESULTS & HARDWARE TELEMETRY

Extensive physical testing was conducted on the RS-380 motor hardware test bench over serial COM5. The motor was subjected to sustained high-speed operational cycles to record transient and steady-state dynamics:

OPERATIONAL PARAMETER	IDLE / STANDBY STATE	MOTOR ACTIVE RUN (180 PWM)	ENGINEERING ASSESSMENT
Rotational Speed (RPM)	0 RPM	8,820 RPM	Nominal operating speed achieved under load.
Motor Terminal Voltage	0.00 V	8.95 V ± 0.15 V	Smooth PWM voltage delivery via H-bridge.
Total Bus Current	0.12 A (standby)	0.58 A avg (2.26 A inrush peak)	Normal inrush transient followed by stable running load.
Motor Branch Current	0.00 A	0.46 A ± 0.08 A	Within continuous operational limits (<1.5 A rating).
Bearing Surface Temperature	31.31 °C	32.26 °C (ΔT = +0.95 °C)	Controlled thermal rise within safe boundary (<60 °C).
Vibration Acceleration	0.18 g (floor noise)	0.39 g RMS (±0.05 g)	Well within ISO 10816-3 Class I Good threshold (<0.71 g).
3S Battery Pack Voltage	12.69 V	12.38 V (under 2A load)	Healthy cell impedance with rapid voltage recovery post-run.
Lithium Cell Balance (ΔV)	0.12 V	0.14 V	Pack balanced (Cell 1: 4.19V, Cell 2: 4.20V, Cell 3: 4.31V).
Predicted RUL	12.59 Hours	12.18 Hours	Smooth monotonic degradation tracking.
Equipment Health State	HEALTHY (Index: 1.0)	HEALTHY (Index: 0.98)	No fault alarms triggered; normal operation verified.

9. SYSTEM FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS VERIFICATION MATRIX

All thirteen functional requirements specified in Section 5.3 of the official project specification were systematically tested against the physical hardware and verified **100% Functional & Compliant**:

REQ #	SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT (PDF SEC 5.3)	IMPLEMENTATION MECHANISM	VERIFICATION STATUS
FR-1	Real-Time Sensor Data Collection	Vibration, temperature, and current sampled at 10 Hz from RS-380 testbed	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-2	ESP32-Based Data Acquisition	FreeRTOS dual-core tasks handling multi-channel ADC conversion	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-3	IIoT-Based Data Transmission	Dual-transport streaming via COM5 serial UART & Wi-Fi UDP 8888	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-4	Data Storage & Processing	SQLite relational database (equipment_health.db) with 3,460+ records	VERIFIED • PASSED

REQ #	SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT (PDF SEC 5.3)	IMPLEMENTATION MECHANISM	VERIFICATION STATUS
FR-5	Equipment Health Assessment	Multi-metric health score indexing based on sensor deviations and limits	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-6	Remaining Useful Life Prediction	Trained Gradient Boosting model estimating RUL in hours ($R^2 = 0.8194$)	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-7	Prediction Interval Generation	Continuous 95% Confidence Interval error bands (± 3.53 hrs)	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-8	SHAP-Based Explainable AI	6-channel attribution calculating exact marginal % impact	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-9	Maintenance Support System	Health indices, multi-stage alert thresholds, and dashboard alerts	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-10	LLM-Based Natural Language Explanation	Context-grounded natural language synthesis of machine conditions	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-11	RAG-Based Knowledge Retrieval	Vectorized search of equipment maintenance manuals & ISO standards	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-12	Intelligent Maintenance Assistant	Dynamic fusion of live telemetry, RUL predictions, SHAP, and RAG context	VERIFIED • PASSED
FR-13	Interactive User Query Interface	Full-stack responsive SCADA chat UI with real-time prompt streaming	VERIFIED • PASSED

10. CONCLUSION & INDUSTRIAL SIGNIFICANCE

The implemented system successfully demonstrates the full integration of IIoT edge sensing, machine learning prognostics, uncertainty quantification, explainable AI, and generative AI maintenance support on physical industrial rotating equipment. Through continuous real-time monitoring and early identification of subtle degradation patterns, the system offers industrial operators significant operational benefits:

- **Unplanned Downtime Reduction:** Transition from reactive failure repair to proactive condition-based scheduling, preventing catastrophic equipment destruction.
- **Transparent Decision-Making:** SHAP feature attribution eliminates "black-box" distrust, empowering technicians with clear mechanical and thermal justifications.
- **Reduced Mean Time to Repair (MTTR):** The integrated RAG/LLM Copilot delivers instant troubleshooting steps and standard operating procedures directly to maintenance personnel.